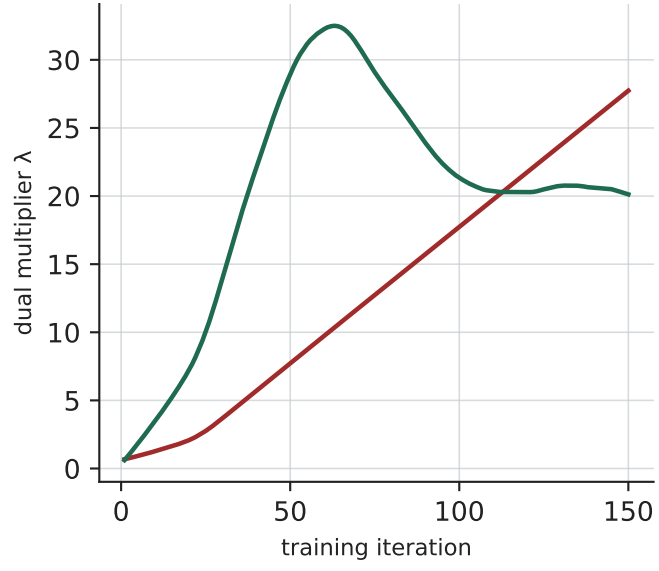
The same planner, with one guard off and on: a policy that runs to the boundary, against one that stays where gradients exist



Defaults (red): pre-tanh reaches 1,436, cost pins at the ceiling from iteration 50, and λ winds up linearly against a quantity that can no longer respond. Guard on (green): pre-tanh settles near 1.9, cost comes inside the budget, and λ rises then RELEASES. One seed each — the eight-seed version is still running.